

Project 5: AI Adoption Index

Kickoff Meeting: 10.01.2026

Course: 95-891 Introduction to AI, Section C, Carnegie Mellon University, Heinz College

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Client: Dr. Julie Agnew (William & Mary), Dr. Rachel Chung (Heinz College)

Meeting Objective: Build a shared understanding of the project, clarify key scope decisions, and align on priorities for the next phase of work.

Agenda

0:00 to 0:10: Introductions & Project Context

Brief introductions and an overview of our current understanding of the project.

0:10 to 0:25: Project Vision & Goals

Dr. Agnew's perspective on the project, intended audience, and what a successful outcome would be.

0:25 to 0:50: Scoping Discussion (Primary questions below)

I. AI Adoption Index

- A. What should "AI Adoption Index" measure (public statements, actual deployment, demonstrated business impact)?
- B. Do you have an existing definition or calculation method in mind, or should our team develop both?

II. Firm & Data Scope

- A. How should we define the initial firm universe? For example, the U.S.-headquartered firms, particular sectors, or a specific size range? Would you prefer a smaller sample with deeper historical coverage? How should we handle firms that do not file 10-Ks or 10-Qs or have limited public disclosures?
- B. Which public sources should we prioritize for tracking adoption over time?

III. AI Taxonomy

- A. Should our team develop the AI-use categories, or build from an existing framework?
- B. Are there areas of AI in retirement where evidence should be treated especially carefully?

IV. Book Chapter

- A. Should the analysis primarily compare retirement recordkeepers with one another, or retirement with other financial sectors?

0:50 to 1:00: Next Steps & Proof of Concept

- What would you most like to see when we reconnect in approximately one month?
- Align on immediate priorities and communication cadence